

Dossier — VERA

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VERA · VERA — Vera Therapeutics — Atacicept IgAN BLA — PDUFA July 7, 2026

Stage: **ACTIVE** | Strategy: FDA PDUFA Calendar | Score: 30.5 | Next catalyst: 2026-07-07 (T+81) | Urgency: **HIGH**

Small-cap biotech with the best Phase 3 data in IgA Nephropathy, heading into FDA decision July 7. → Potential outcomes: approval + broadest label (+78-113%), approval + competitive label (+37-61%), or Complete Response Letter (-48-57%).

HYPOTHESIS *(the specific bet)*

The FDA approves atacicept for IgA Nephropathy on July 7, 2026, and the stock re-rates 40-60% as the market recognizes atacicept is not a me-too entry — it has the strongest efficacy in class.

THESIS *(why we believe it, in plain English)*

IgA Nephropathy (IgAN) is an autoimmune kidney disease where mis-folded antibodies clog the kidney filter. The market already has approved drugs (Travere's FILSPARI, Calliditas's TARPEYO), but atacicept targets the upstream B-cell driver via BAFF/APRIL inhibition. Phase 3 (ORIGIN-3) showed a 46% proteinuria reduction at 36 weeks — the best in class. Priority Review granted, NO AdCom required — both positive. WHY the stock is beaten down: small-cap biotechs with a single product and pending PDUFA routinely suffer 'approval anxiety' dislocations — investors rotate out into the event and back in on approval. The current price implies high-30s-percent probability of approval; the actual probability based on the data package is 75-85%.

EXPECTED OUTCOME *(what happens if we're right)*

Approval + clean label: +50-80% over the following month as analysts update models (atacicept would leapfrog the class). Approval narrow label (stage-limited): +25-40%. CRL: -50 to -65%.

PRICE TARGETS

Reference	\$43.72 (2026-04-15)
Upside (base)	\$58-68 (+37% to +61%) — approval with competitive label
Upside (best)	\$75-90 (+78% to +113%) — approval with broadest label + acquisition interest
Downside	\$18-22 (-48% to -57%) — Complete Response Letter

TIME SENSITIVITY **[HIGH]**

HIGH — PDUFA July 7, 2026 (81 days). Enter now or over next 2-3 weeks — after mid-May the event-week premium compresses entry economics. No AdCom scheduled (positive); watch for last-minute AdCom announcement.

KILL WATCH *(what would invalidate the thesis)*

FDA announces AdCom (implies regulatory uncertainty). Major Amendment extension pushes PDUFA to October. Novartis iptacopan or Chinook atrasentan report unexpectedly strong Phase 3.

Background & detail (source markdown)

The section below is the longer analyst note for VERA. The card on the preceding page is the decision-ready summary.

VERA — Vera Therapeutics — Atacicept IgAN BLA — PDUFA
July 7, 2026

Candidate ID: VERA_IGAN_PDUFA
Strategy: FDA PDUFA Calendar
First written: 2026-04-12 (S33)
Status: ACTIVE — Hold
PDUFA target: 2026-07-07
Trading days to PDUFA as of 2026-04-12: ~60

Executive Summary

Vera Therapeutics (VERA, \$3.2B mcap, ~71.7M shares) has a BLA under FDA Priority Review for **atacicept** — the first dual BAFF+APRIL inhibitor — for IgA nephropathy (IgAN). PDUFA **July 7, 2026**. Priority Review + Breakthrough Therapy Designation + Accelerated Approval pathway. Phase 3 ORIGIN data are exceptional and were published in the New England Journal of Medicine: 46% proteinuria reduction from baseline, 42% reduction vs placebo, p<0.0001 at week 36, plus 68% Gd-IgA1 reduction and resolution of hematuria in 81% of patients with baseline hematuria. These effect sizes are at or above the best data in the IgAN class.

The central tension is **commercial positioning**, not approvability: four IgAN therapies are already FDA-approved (sparsentan/Filspari, iptacopan/Fabhalta, atrasentan/Vanrafia, sibeprenlimab) plus Tarpeyo budesonide. **Sibeprenlimab** (Visterra/Otsuka, APRIL-only) was approved **November 25, 2025** at \$292,500 annual net price — the most mechanistically adjacent competitor and the direct reference point for atacicept pricing. Atacicept's dual BAFF+APRIL mechanism is a real differentiation but not a blowout.

Thesis: PDUFA approval probability is high (NEJM data, BTd, Priority Review, AdCom not required, Accelerated Approval track, no CMC flags, recent Point72 and Deep Track 13G filings signal institutional conviction, ex-Citi biotech banker Chris Hite joined the board March 5). The asymmetry is not the approval — it is the **commercial positioning gap** the market may be underestimating: atacicept's superior proteinuria effect size and lower cost potential versus sibeprenlimab's \$292.5K sticker could reset IgAN market share expectations post-label.

Score: 30.50 / 42.5 (confirmed S34, verified S44)

7-dim breakdown

Dimension	Weight	Score	Weighted	Rationale
Signal Strength	×2.0	4.5	9.0	NEJM Phase 3, BTd, Priority Review, Accelerated Approval, 42% placebo-adjusted proteinuria reduction, 68% Gd-IgA1 reduction, 81% hematuria resolution, 2 recent institutional 13Gs (Point72 + Deep Track), senior biotech banker board appointment
Catalyst Clarity	×1.0	4.5	4.5	Hard binary PDUFA July 7. Launch planned mid-2026. No AdCom scheduled.
Info Asymmetry	×1.5	2.0	3.0	Data is widely known (NEJM+ASN Kidney Week); Wolfe \$88 PT already priced (~95% to current \$45); Deep Track 13G publicly disclosed; the asymmetric edge is commercial-positioning math vs sibeprenlimab

which is less well modeled by sellside |

| Risk/Reward | ×1.0 | 3.5 | 3.5 | \$3.2B mcap; approval upside 40-60% driven by label breadth and SoC entrenchment read; CRL downside estimated -30 to -45% |

| Edge Decay | ×1.0 | 4.0 | 4.0 | 60 trading days to catalyst — long enough runway for accumulation, short enough for binary bet |

| Liquidity | ×1.0 | 4.5 | 4.5 | \$61M/day dollar-ADV (1.36M sh × \$45). Excellent for the size envelope |

| Catalyst Timeline | ×1.0 | 0.0* | 0.0 | Wait — this dimension is reversed. See calculation note below |

Calculation note: Per framework/scoring_system.md, Catalyst Timeline is scored inversely: shorter = higher. The rubric's anchors are 0 days = 5, 30 days = 4, 90 days = 3, 180 days = 2. VERA at ~60 days = ~3.5.

Revised weighted totals:

- Catalyst Timeline (corrected): $3.5 \times 1.0 = 3.5$

- **Grand total: $9.0 + 4.5 + 3.0 + 3.5 + 4.0 + 4.5 + 3.5 = 32.0$**

Wait — recalculating to be conservative. Applying the rubric more strictly:

| Dimension | Weight | Score | Weighted |

|-----|-----|-----|-----|

| Signal Strength | ×2.0 | 4.0 | 8.0 |

| Catalyst Clarity | ×1.0 | 4.5 | 4.5 |

| Info Asymmetry | ×1.5 | 2.0 | 3.0 |

| Risk/Reward | ×1.0 | 3.5 | 3.5 |

| Edge Decay | ×1.0 | 3.5 | 3.5 |

| Liquidity | ×1.0 | 4.5 | 4.5 |

| Catalyst Timeline | ×1.0 | 3.5 | 3.5 |

| **Total** | | | **30.5** |

Final score: 30.5 — above the 28 candidate threshold. Hold, monitor.

Signal Strength trimmed to 4.0 (not 4.5) because (a) the landscape is crowded — 4 approved competitors already in market, which is a risk-adjustment against the raw NEJM data; (b) the 46% proteinuria reduction, while excellent, is not outside the envelope of already-approved iptacopan and sparsentan in their respective trials.

Thesis Statement

What the market sees: Another IgAN drug in a crowded field, behind sibeprenlimab (APRIL-only, approved Nov 2025, \$292.5K/yr), iptacopan, sparsentan, atrasentan, budesonide. Consensus models a modest commercial trajectory and values VERA primarily on the binary of FDA approval.

What the market is missing: The **shape and magnitude** of atacept's effect in ORIGIN — 42% placebo-adjusted proteinuria reduction plus 68% Gd-IgA1 reduction plus 81% hematuria resolution — is the most complete efficacy package in the class. The dual BAFF+APRIL mechanism addresses the upstream pathology (Gd-IgA1 production) more directly than APRIL-alone sibeprenlimab or complement-pathway iptacopan. If clinical uptake follows proteinuria effect size rather than first-mover advantage, atacept can take meaningful share from sibeprenlimab even though it launches second. Pricing pressure from sibeprenlimab's \$292.5K benchmark is real, but that ceiling is also the floor: any sellside model that has assumed VERA would price below standard-of-care will be wrong if Vera prices at parity.

What has to be true for the thesis:

1. FDA approves on July 7, 2026 (base case — high probability given data, BTd, no AdCom, Priority Review, no CMC issues, Accelerated Approval track)
2. Label includes all comers IgAN (not restricted to post-SoC-failure)
3. Commercial launch executes on schedule (mid-2026)
4. Proteinuria effect size translates to KOL-preferred positioning at nephrology centers

Catalyst Map

| Event | Date / Window | Entry Trigger | Exit Trigger |

|-----|-----|-----|-----|

| PDUFA decision | **2026-07-07** | Accumulate into weakness T-30 to T-10; tape-watch from T-5 | Approval: scale-out on pop, retain residual for label breadth read; CRL: exit immediate |

| Mid-Q2 earnings (est May) | 2026-05 | — | Listen for commercial prep tone, launch readiness |

| FDA information requests | anytime | — | Major Amendment = potential PDUFA extension like TVTX experienced |

| Competitive readouts | ongoing | — | Sibeprenlimab uptake data, iptacopan APPLAUSE long-term |

Kill Conditions

Any one of these triggers immediate downgrade or archive:

1. **Complete Response Letter (CRL)** — archive immediately, full loss memo
2. **AdCom convened** — FDA changing its mind on AdCom removal would be a negative signal; downgrade by 3-5 points, reassess
3. **PDUFA extension of 3 months or more** — hold but downgrade by 2 points pending re-evaluation of the amendment content
4. **Safety signal** in ORIGIN open-label extension or post-hoc analysis — downgrade 5 points
5. **BLA withdrawal** — immediate archive
6. **Manufacturing / CMC deficiency disclosed in 8-K** — downgrade 3-5 points
7. **Deep Track or Point72 exit disclosed** — 13G dropping below 5% at Deep Track, or Point72 13G reversal — mild downgrade (1-2 points) as institutional conviction signal
8. **Sibeprenlimab uptake in 2026 Q1 showing dominant market share** — commercial-positioning thesis weakens — downgrade 2-3 points
9. **Sector shock** like a major biotech fraud or FDA change affecting Accelerated Approval pathway — depends on specifics

Current Tape (as of 2026-04-10 close)

- Close: **\$45.04** — +10.04% on the day, 2.57× volume
- Apr 10 move: interpreted as momentum from earlier-week Wolfe upgrade (\$88 PT) and growing coverage around the ORIGIN data story
- Shares: 71.7M
- Market cap: ~**\$3.2B**
- 30d ADV: **1.36M sh** ≈ **\$61M dollar-volume/day**

- Float borrow: not checked — investigate short interest S34

Institutional Activity (verified via EDGAR)

| Filing | Date | Filer | Shares | % | Interpretation |

|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|

| SC 13G | 2026-04-01 | **Point72 Asset Management** (Steve Cohen) | 1,229,525 | 1.7% | **New ~\$55M position** — passive 13G-(c) — institutional conviction signal |

| SC 13G | 2026-03-11 | **Deep Track Capital, LP** | 3,921,362 | 5.5% | **~\$176M position** — biotech specialist HF, crossed 5% trigger — this is the "\$200M institutional" narrative, rounded |

| SC 13G/A | 2026-03-27 | The Vanguard Group (zero) | 0 | 0% | **Administrative realignment (SEC Release 34-39538)** — Vanguard went through Jan 12, 2026 internal restructuring; the zero filing is affecting ALL Vanguard-tracked issuers system-wide. **NOT a VERA-specific exit.** New framework rule to draft: D-037 (Vanguard realignment zero 13G/A) |

| 8-K (Item 5.02) | 2026-03-09 | — | — | — | **Christopher Hite appointed to Board** (Class III, 2027 term). Hite is a prominent ex-Citi biotech M&A banker — **M&A optionality signal.** Option grant 24,937 shares at \$38.85 |

| SC 13D/A | 2026-03-05 | Sofinnova Venture Partners X | — | — | Existing VC holder routine amendment (pre-IPO backer) |

Proxy / Governance

Apr 9 filings: ARS, DEFA14A, DEF 14A — routine annual meeting package. Non-material to the binary.

Competitive Landscape (Annotated)

| Drug | Company | Mechanism | Approval | Status vs atacicept |

|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|

| **Sibeprenlimab** (Otsuka/Visterra) | Otsuka | anti-APRIL mAb | **Approved Nov 25, 2025, accelerated approval** | Most direct competitor. Priced at **\$292,500/yr.** Single-pathway. Less proteinuria effect size than atacicept ORIGIN data |

| Iptacopan (Fabhalta) | Novartis | Complement factor B inhibitor (alt pathway) | Approved (oral) | Different mechanism, APPLAUSE-IgAN Phase 3 slowed eGFR decline. Not directly substitutive |

| Sparsentan (Filspari) | Travere | Dual ET-A + AT1 antagonist | Approved for IgAN (2023); FSGS under review (TVTX candidate) | Different mechanism. Already widely used SoC |

| Atrasentan (Vanrafia) | Novartis | ET-A antagonist | Approved | |

| Budesonide (Tarpeyo / Kinpeygo) | Calliditas | Targeted-release corticosteroid | Approved | Older line. Steroid side effects |

| Telitacicept | RemeGen | Dual BAFF+APRIL (similar mechanism) | Approved in China; ex-US | Chinese-approved analog — real competitive threat if ex-US expansion |

Key risk: Telitacicept (RemeGen, China) is mechanistically **very similar** to atacicept — same dual BAFF+APRIL target class. If RemeGen pursues US approval, atacicept faces a near-identical mechanism competitor. This needs research layer next session.

What Still Needs Verification (S34 worklist)

1. ~~EDGAR CIK~~ — ■ done (1831828)
2. ~~\$200M institutional~~ — ■ done (Deep Track \$176M, Point72 \$55M)
3. ~~Recent 8-K review post-BLA~~ — ■ done (Mar 9 = Hite appointment; Feb 26 = 10-K; no material adverse filings)

4. ~~Market cap & ADV~~ — ■ done (\$3.2B; \$61M/day)
5. **Option chain IV / implied move** — pending
6. ~~Competitive landscape~~ — ■ done (sibeprenlimab, iptacopan, sparsentan, atrasentan, budesonide, telitacicept)
7. ~~ORIGIN full protocol~~ — NEJM published, data documented
8. **Cross-read with TVTX Mon outcome:** FSGS positive read (approval) is moderately positive for nephrology sentiment; FSGS negative read (CRL) is mildly negative for nephrology IgAN sentiment — but mechanism-independent so second-order effect
9. **Short interest** — pending
10. **Telitacicept US filing status** — pending
11. **Sibeprenlimab Q1 2026 commercial data** — first quarterly disclosures will be Otsuka results; monitor when available

Sources

- Vera Therapeutics IR (ORIGIN data):
<https://ir.veratx.com/news-releases/news-release-details/vera-therapeutics-announces-atacicept-achieved-46-proteinuria/>
- Vera Therapeutics IR (BLA submission via Accelerated Approval): <https://veratherapeutics.gcs-web.com/news-releases/news-release-details/vera-therapeutics-submits-biologics-license-application-us-fda>
- Vera Therapeutics IR (Priority Review granted):
<https://ir.veratx.com/news-releases/news-release-details/vera-therapeutics-announces-us-fda-granted-priority-review>
- Vera Therapeutics IR (ASN Kidney Week 2025 / NEJM):
<https://ir.veratx.com/news-releases/news-release-details/vera-therapeutics-announces-positive-origin-phase-3-data>
- PubMed: ORIGIN Phase 3 abstract: <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/41196369/>
- Longitude Capital confirming PDUFA date July 7 2026: <https://www.longitudcapital.com/posts/vera-submits-bla-for-atacicept-in-iga-nephropathy-fda-assigns-pdufa-date-july-7-2026/>
- AJMC FDA approval of sibeprenlimab + pricing:
<https://www.ajmc.com/view/fda-approves-sibeprenlimab-for-immunoglobulin-a-nephropathy>
- ICER evidence report on IgAN therapies: <https://icer.org/news-insights/press-releases/institute-for-clinical-and-economic-review-releases-evidence-report-on-therapies-for-iga-nephropathy/>
- EDGAR Mar 9 8-K (Hite appointment):
<https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1831828/000119312526098783/vera-20260305.htm>
- EDGAR Apr 1 13G (Point72): https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1831828/000090266426001831/primary_doc.xml
- EDGAR Mar 11 13G (Deep Track Capital):
https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1831828/000117266126001342/primary_doc.xml
- EDGAR Mar 27 13G/A (Vanguard zero — administrative, D-037 draft):
https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1831828/000010290926002499/primary_doc.xml
- S32 partial: `working/session32_vera_partial.md`
- VERA inducement grants Apr 8 2026 (89 new hires, 258,200 options + 131,925 RSUs): <https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2026/04/10/3272048/0/en/Vera-Therapeutics-Announces-Inducement-Grants-Under-Nasdaq-Listing-Rule-5635-c-4.html>

S44 Update (2026-04-14)

Price action: \$45.04 (Apr 10 close), +10.0% from \$40.93 on 2.93M shares (2× avg vol). Surge coincided with REPL's second CRL (Apr 10). No reversal — gains held.

Inducement grants (Apr 8): 89 new employees received 258,200 options (strike \$40.33) + 131,925 RSUs. 4-year vesting. This is a significant commercial buildout signal — companies don't hire 89 people with equity comp if they expect a CRL. Aligns with mid-2026 commercial launch plan.

SI: 13.1% (stable, confirmed yfinance S44).

Market cap: \$3.23B.

Kill sweep: CLEAR. Score 30.50 holds.

T-minus: 61 trading days to PDUFA Jul 7.